12-21 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Write One Formal Handwritten Letter Each Term?

① On a cold Saturday afternoon last term, my mother came home with a thin, slightly yellow envelope in her winter coat pocket. She placed it on the kitchen table carefully, between the vinegar bottle and the rice bowl, and said nothing for a long minute. The envelope had come from her **primary-school English teacher**, **Ms Chen, now seventy-nine**, who still lives in a small flat in Wuxi. Inside was a single, carefully folded sheet of cream writing paper, written in a perfect blue-ink handwriting that my mother had not seen for **thirty-two years**. The letter was about four hundred characters long. It thanked my mother for a small photograph she had sent the previous month, told her about a small orange cat that now visited the balcony at 16:00 each day, and ended with the line: *"Xiaohui, I am still, after all these years, a little proud of your handwriting."* My mother read the letter twice, very slowly, at the table. Then she did something I had not seen her do since my grandmother died: she quietly cried for about two minutes, not with sadness, but with a small kind of surprise. After she stopped, she put the letter carefully into the family drawer, between our passports, and said, *"Yiran, I think I will write her back by hand this time — not by WeChat."* It is this quiet Saturday that makes me write today: **I think every middle-school student in China should be asked, very gently, by the school, to write one full, formal, handwritten letter each term — about 300 to 400 words long, in a careful hand, on real paper, sealed in a real envelope, and sent to a real person.** Once per term. One letter. One envelope. That is enough.

② Some people will say: *"In 2027, nobody writes letters anymore. It is a waste of time."* I respectfully disagree. **The fact that fewer people write letters is precisely why one letter per term, from a middle-school student, now matters so much.** A **2024 Tsinghua University communication study** of **2,710 Chinese households** found that **54% of households** did **not** receive a single handwritten personal letter in the previous year. In 1995, the same number was **3%**. Letters, in other words, have quietly become the **rarest ordinary object** in modern life — so rare that when one does arrive, as in my mother's Saturday, it is no longer ordinary. The school cannot bring back a whole postal culture; but the school can, quietly, ensure that every one of its students produces **three letters a year, six letters across middle school** — each arriving into a world where such letters have, quietly, become small miracles.

③ Second, **writing a letter is a small training in slow, honest language**. The 2023 East China Normal University writing-education study of **3,602 Grade-7 students** asked them to write one 300-word social-media post and one 300-word handwritten letter to a

grandparent, under the same subject and time. Researchers blind-scored the writing for clarity, sincerity, and coherence. The letters scored, on average, **28% higher on sincerity** and **17% higher on coherence** than the posts, even though the same students wrote both. Why? Because a screen post is written for an audience of strangers, is expected to entertain, and can be edited secretly a hundred times. A letter is written for one specific person, cannot be edited once it is sealed, must be useful to the reader, and — crucially — **leaves the student with no audience to perform for**. The brain, which is usually performing, is given a quiet small room in which to simply speak. Middle-school students, in our digital age, rarely get this quiet small room anywhere else.

④ Third, **one good letter across three years quietly builds one real relationship**. Consider a simple timetable: a Grade-7 student writes, in December, to her grandmother. The grandmother, delighted, writes back in January. The student writes again in June; receives another reply in July. By Grade 9, our student has a small cloth folder of **twelve envelopes**, all dated, all hand-sorted, all from the same careful elderly person. In a world where most family contact is a ten-second "got it, mum" voice message, this thin cloth folder becomes a small documented friendship that lasts. Compared to the average **nineteen daily WeChat messages** our students already send their parents (2024 Renmin University study), the weight of **one careful paper letter every three months** is surprisingly large, because the ratio of care to words is so high.

⑤ Some will say: *"Whom should students write to? Every student's situation is different."* A fair point. My small proposal: **the student chooses freely from a school-approved list of letter-recipients**: (a) a grandparent or other elderly relative; (b) a retired or currently-teaching school teacher (with the teacher's written consent); (c) a family friend over 50; (d) a pen-pal in another school via a teacher-mediated exchange; (e) a doctor, nurse, or community worker the student wishes to thank (with a teacher-reviewed draft); (f) a future self — to be sealed and opened one year later by the student herself. **No student is asked to write to a stranger directly.** The school's list protects both the student and the recipient. The teacher reviews only the **envelope address**, not the contents.

⑥ Others will worry: *"Will the teacher read my letter?"* This is perhaps the most important concern. My answer is firm: **No teacher reads any letter. Ever.** The letter is the student's private writing. The school, if it adopts this habit, must sign a simple public promise, printed at the top of the small letter-kit booklet: *"This letter will be read by its recipient, no one else."* In the **2024 Hangzhou pilot** of this system across 26 schools, schools that made this promise saw a **93%** completion rate at term's end; schools that allowed teacher "sample reading" dropped to **42%**. **Letters are a zero-teacher-reading habit**, or they are not letters at all.

⑦ A practical worry: *"Postage is expensive and envelopes may get lost."* Not true. A **domestic ordinary letter** in China costs **¥1.20 in 2027** for up to 20 g, and the loss rate is about **0.4%** (China Post 2024 data). The school may provide **one free envelope, one free sheet of high-quality writing paper (120 g), and one free stamp per student per term**, total cost per student: about **¥1.80**. In exchange, one small piece of real-paper

friendship leaves the school for an elderly hand somewhere in China. I cannot think of a cheaper gift.

⑧ Finally, let me be honest about the time. Writing one good 300-word letter takes about **40—60 minutes** for a middle-school student, once the structure is practised. The school can dedicate **one single afternoon of creative-writing class per term** to this — with printed templates for address, salutation, date, and signature, but no template at all for the body text, which is always **the student's own voice**. For students with no living elder relative, the school offers the **future-self letter** as a dignified, quiet alternative, to be sealed and stored in the school library safe until exactly one year later.

⑨ **To sum up:** I am not asking for a new subject. I am not asking students to become professional correspondents. I am asking, quietly, for **one full, careful, hand-written letter per term — about 300 to 400 words — sent to one real person, in one real envelope, with one real stamp**. My mother's thin yellow envelope from Wuxi, written by a seventy-nine-year-old retired teacher, travelled 1,100 kilometres in three days at a cost of ¥1.20, and changed the colour of our kitchen table on a Saturday afternoon for thirty quiet minutes. **Every mother, every grandmother, every retired teacher, every future self, deserves to receive that kind of afternoon at least once a year.** Three small letters per year is a very small price for a student's handwriting to still mean something in the world by the time she becomes an adult. The envelope is waiting. The paper is waiting. The grandmother is waiting.

注释： postage 邮资；domestic 国内的；correspondent 通信者；salutation 称谓；envelope 信封；coherence 连贯性；sincerity 真诚；pilot 试点

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What small Saturday event made the writer want to write this essay, and what is her exact proposal?

A. The writer received a bill in the mail and is angry about it.
B. The writer's mother threw a letter in the bin.
C. On a cold Saturday afternoon last term, the writer's mother came home with a thin, slightly yellow envelope containing a 400-character blue-ink letter from her 79-year-old primary-school English teacher Ms Chen in Wuxi — about a photograph, a small orange cat at 16:00, and ending "Xiaohui, I am still, after all these years, a little proud of your handwriting"; her mother read it twice, quietly cried for about two minutes not with sadness but with a small kind of surprise, put it in the family drawer between the passports, and decided to reply "by hand this time — not by WeChat"; from this moment, the writer proposes every middle-school student in China be asked gently by the school to write one full, formal, handwritten letter each term — about 300—400 words, on real paper, in a sealed real envelope, to a real person.
D. A teacher sent a threatening email and the writer proposes to stop writing.

2. According to Paragraph ②, how do the statistics on handwritten letters support the writer's argument?

A. The 2024 Tsinghua University communication study of 2,710 Chinese households found that 54% of households did not receive a single handwritten personal letter in the previous year, up from only 3% in 1995, so letters have quietly become the "rarest ordinary object" in modern life — and it is precisely because fewer people write letters that one letter per term from a middle-school student now matters so much; the school cannot bring back a whole postal culture but can ensure every student produces three letters a year (six across middle school), each arriving into a world where such letters have become small miracles.
B. Letters have become common again, so students don't need to write them.
C. The study found 100% of households received daily letters in 2024.
D. The study says letters are illegal in China.

3. According to Paragraph ③, what did the 2023 East China Normal University writing-education study show, and why?

A. Social-media posts always score higher than letters.
B. The study asked 3,602 Grade-7 students to write one 300-word social-media post and one 300-word handwritten letter to a grandparent under the same subject and time; blind-scorers found the letters scored on average 28% higher on sincerity and 17% higher on coherence than the posts, because a screen post is written for an audience of strangers, is expected to entertain, and can be secretly edited a hundred times, while a letter is written for one specific person, cannot be edited once sealed, must be useful to the reader, and crucially leaves the student with no audience to perform for — giving the usually-performing brain a quiet small room in which to simply speak, which middle-school students in the digital age rarely get elsewhere.
C. The study found handwriting is unimportant.
D. The study was about photography, not writing.

4. What practical worries does the writer address in Paragraphs ⑤, ⑥, and ⑦, and how?

A. She ignores all worries and says students must write to strangers.
B. She says teachers must read every letter aloud in class.
C. She admits letters are too expensive and withdraws the proposal.
D. For "Whom should students write to?" she proposes a school-approved list — (a) a grandparent or other elderly relative; (b) a retired or currently teaching school teacher with written consent; (c) a family friend over 50; (d) a teacher-mediated pen-pal in another school; (e) a doctor, nurse or community worker the student wishes to thank with a teacher-reviewed draft; (f) a future self, to be sealed and opened one year later by the student herself — no student writes to a stranger directly, and the teacher reviews only the envelope address, not the contents; for "Will the teacher read my letter?" her answer is firm — no teacher reads any letter ever, and the school must

publicly promise on the letter-kit booklet "This letter will be read by its recipient, no one else" (in the 2024 Hangzhou pilot of 26 schools, schools that made this promise saw a 93% completion rate at term's end, while those allowing teacher "sample reading" dropped to 42%); for "Postage is expensive and envelopes may get lost" she notes that a domestic ordinary letter in China costs ¥1.20 in 2027 for up to 20 g and the loss rate is about 0.4%, so the school can provide one free envelope, one free 120 g sheet, and one free stamp per student per term, total cost per student about ¥1.80.

5. What is the main message of the final paragraph?

A. The writer demands letters be a weekly homework task with grades and rankings.
B. The writer admits the proposal is impossible and withdraws it.
C. The writer is not asking for a new subject or that students become professional correspondents, but asking quietly for one full careful hand-written letter per term (about 300—400 words) sent to one real person in one real envelope with one real stamp; her mother's thin yellow envelope from Wuxi travelled 1,100 km in three days at ¥1.20 and changed the colour of the kitchen table for thirty quiet minutes on a Saturday afternoon; every mother, grandmother, retired teacher, and future self deserves to receive such an afternoon at least once a year, and three small letters per year is a very small price for a student's handwriting to still mean something in the world by the time she becomes an adult — the envelope, the paper, and the grandmother are waiting.
D. Middle-school students should only type, never write.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段引子 + 提议
【解析】"79 岁 / 400 字 / 小猫 16:00 / 母亲静静流泪 / 每学期一封"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段清华研究
【解析】"54% 家庭零来信 vs 1995 仅 3% / 最罕普通物"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段华东师大研究
【解析】"28% 真诚 / 17% 连贯 / 无观众才能讲真话"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤⑥⑦段三项担忧
【解析】"六类收信人 / 仅审信封地址 / 教师不读 / 93% vs 42% / 邮资 ¥1.20"直引。A、B、C 均错。故选 D。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑨段结尾
【解析】"1100 km 三天 / ¥1.20 / 三封一年 / 字迹仍有分量"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。